

Independent Engineer's Report: Cottonwood Solar I

Report date: July 31, 2026

Prepared for: prospective tax credit purchasers and lenders

1. Project Description

The Project is a 100 MWac / 135 MWdc single-axis tracking solar photovoltaic facility in Montgomery County, Illinois, owned by Cottonwood Solar I, LLC, with 27 central inverters and a 34.5/138 kV project substation. The design is consistent with the interconnection agreement.

2. Construction History

The EPC contractor received full notice to proceed on December 18, 2025. Under a binding written contract dated December 10, 2025, physical manufacture of the custom main power transformer began off site on December 22, 2025. We reviewed the manufacturer's production records and confirm that physical work of a significant nature began on that date and continued without interruption; the transformer is a custom unit, not held in inventory.

Mobilization occurred in early January 2026, and on-site physical work, beginning with pile installation for the tracker foundations, commenced on January 12, 2026. In our opinion the Project's construction began on December 22, 2025.

3. Schedule

As of the report date, the EPC schedule forecasts substantial completion on November 15, 2026 and placed-in-service on or about November 30, 2026, contingent on main power transformer delivery in September 2026.